



ANCIENT ENIGMA

This fossil belongs to a creature called *Seymouria*. Although its large backbone and strong limbs suggested it might have been a land dweller, research has shown that it began its life as an aquatic tadpolelike larva, just as modern amphibians do. However, it was not an amphibian and was instead more closely related to modern-day reptiles and mammals. At 24 in (60 cm) in length, *Seymouria* was twice the size of today's goliath frog, the largest frog on Earth.